

Choosing **DevOps** as a Career: Things You Should Know



DevOps is the new buzzword in the IT field, following Agile and Scrum. People with DevOps skills are in great demand because businesses get great results from it. Let's explore what DevOps is all about, what DevOps engineers do, and how readers could build careers in this space.

DevOps is a combination of software development techniques that combine software development (Dev) and IT operations (Ops) to enable the delivery of features, bug fixes and updates more frequently – all of which are aligned with business requirements. In simple language, we can say that DevOps cuts down the software development life cycle timeline.

Does this mean DevOps and Agile are related?

While from the definition perspective, both terms look pretty similar or are almost synonyms, in reality, they differ.



Figure 1: Components of DevOps

Agile bridges the communication gap between customers/stakeholders and developers, while DevOps brings together developers and IT operations/infrastructure. More specifically, DevOps focuses on the deployment of developed software, irrespective of methodology — Agile or traditional (Water Fall).

DevOps processes

DevOps itself includes the regular software development life cycle steps, in the following order.

- **Coding:** Code development and review, source code management tools and code merging
- **Building:** Continuous integration tools and build status
- **Testing:** Continuous testing tools that provide feedback on business risks
- **Packaging:** Artefact repository and application pre-deployment staging
- **Releasing:** Change management, release approvals and release automation
- **Configuring:** Infrastructure configuration and management, as well as 'infrastructure as code' tools

- **Monitoring:** Applications performance monitoring and end user experience

The role of the delivery pipeline in DevOps

Continuous integration and continuous delivery are the most important components of DevOps. Continuous delivery (CD) is a software strategy that enables organisations to deliver new features to users as fast and as efficiently as possible. The core idea of CD is to create a repeatable, reliable and incrementally improving process in order to take software from concept to customer. The goal of continuous delivery is to enable a constant flow of changes into production via an automated software production line. The CD pipeline is what makes it all happen.

What makes a DevOps team?

1. **Product owner:** This person is at the intersection between the team and the customer, and is the one who understands how the app should run to deliver value to the users and what cloud infrastructure is needed to support